SPECIAL CONSIDERATION PROCEDURE

SCOPE

This procedure applies to all Monash University staff, students and assessment in coursework units.

For assessment of the research component (e.g. thesis) of a graduate research degree, refer to the Graduate Research Thesis Examination Procedures.

For the purpose of this procedure, references to 'the University' includes activities of Monash University Australia, Monash University Malaysia, Monash University Indonesia, Monash Suzhou, and the Monash University Prato Centre, unless indicated otherwise.

PROCEDURE STATEMENT

This procedure describes the process and criteria for short extensions and special consideration applications for all assessments in a teaching period. Short extensions and special consideration apply to graded assessment tasks recorded in Moodle. The procedure also describes the process and criteria for rescheduled deferred assessment applications and withdrawn grade applications.

For adjustments to assessments for students registered with Disability Support Services see section 6 of the Assessment Regime Procedure.

In this procedure, references to the associate dean (education) may include roles with equivalent responsibility within the faculty, such as deputy dean (education), associate dean (learning and teaching), associate dean (graduate research), at Malaysia, the deputy head of school (education), at Indonesia, the chair of the Campus Education Committee, or at Monash Suzhou, the associate dean (education).

1. Short extensions

1.1. Short extensions of two calendar days are available for students experiencing short term difficult circumstances.

1.1.1. A short extension is available for each eligible assessment task (see 1.2) and can be granted once for each task.

1.1.2. Any additional extension requests for the same assessment task will require a special consideration application (see 2).

1.2. Short extensions are not available for group assessments, in-class tests/assessments (including presentations), practical assessments (including laboratories), mid-semester tests, or scheduled final assessments. For these assessment types students must instead apply for special consideration (see 2).

1.3. Short extensions will not be granted if the student has already attempted the assessment task, or, if multiple attempts are permitted for the task (e.g. quizzes) and the student has exhausted all attempts.

1.4. Applications for short extensions must be submitted as soon as possible but not later than 11:55pm (the time zone of the unit location) on the due date of the affected assessment task.

1.4.1. Students are not required to provide a reason (e.g. medical health condition) for the first short extension application in each unit. A reason will only be required for any subsequent short extension applications for other assessments in the same unit.

1.4.2. Supporting evidence (e.g. doctor's certificate) is not required.

1.4.3. Late applications are not accepted. In this situation students can apply for special consideration (see 2.11).

1.5. Student Services will assess the application and notify the student of the outcome within one working day.

Complex arrangements

1.6. Assessment tasks that are eligible for a short extension (see 1.2) may require complex arrangements to be put in place. Complex arrangements are required when an extension for a specific assessment task is not possible. It may include assessment tasks such as quizzes or assignments.

1.7. Complex arrangements must be communicated to Student Services in the specified manner and timeframe.

1.8. When an application is received for an eligible assessment with a complex arrangement, the chief examiner (or delegate) will review the application and notify the student of the outcome within one working day.

1.9. Where a short extension cannot be accommodated for an assessment task, the chief examiner (or delegate) may either

- provide an alternative assessment task, or
- exempt the student from completing the task if the assessment task is weighted 10 percent or less (see Table 1 and 2.25).

1.10. The due date for an approved short extension can be any day except a University holiday or a day on which the student has a scheduled final assessment. The rules relating to assessment task submission dates do not apply to extensions (see Assessment Regime Procedure 3.3 to 3.5).

2. Special consideration

Eligibility

2.1. Special consideration is available for students who are unable to undertake or complete an assessment task due to immediate and exceptional circumstances beyond their control (see Table 1), except as outlined in section 2.4.

2.2. Special consideration will not be granted for:

- voluntary representation at club or society activities;
- losing access to the learning management system because a compulsory module/s was not completed by the due date;
- misreading the assessment submission date, including the final scheduled assessments timetable;
- information technology or communication technology related issues that could have been prevented, or the effects minimised, with reasonable diligence by students (e.g. uploading correct files, allowing sufficient time to upload, ensuring the equipment is suitable, failing to save or back up documents or files);
- scheduled final assessments, where students experienced a technical issue such as a brief interruption to power and/or internet service provision, and where the issue was resolved and the student received additional time to complete the assessment;
- supplementary assessments;
- additional assessment on a competency hurdle task; or
- rescheduled deferred assessments.

2.3. Special consideration does not provide a second attempt at an assessment that the student has already attempted, nor is it an opportunity to resubmit an assessment task they have already submitted for marking. To be eligible, students must not have:

- already submitted the assessment task for marking;
- already performed an assessment task e.g. presentation, labs; or
- attended or attempted the whole or part of a scheduled final assessment. An application will be considered by the Senior Director, Student Services (or delegate) when students are determined to be unfit to continue by a medical professional at the assessment venue (or online equivalent).

2.3.1. For assessments where multiple attempts are permitted (e.g. quizzes), students are not eligible for special consideration if they have exhausted all attempts.

2.4. The dean (or delegate) of the teaching faculty may approve certain assessment types that are not available for special consideration. This will be recorded in the unit entry of the Handbook. Students who are unable to complete an assessment task of this type must contact the chief examiner (or delegate) who will determine alternative arrangements.

Supporting evidence requirements

2.5. All supporting evidence must clearly demonstrate the impact the circumstances had on the student's ability to undertake the assessment task.

2.6. All supporting evidence either must be written in English or accompanied by an authorised translation (e.g. National Accreditation Authority for Translators and Interpreters). Any statements or evidence written by the student must be written in English.

2.7. Supporting evidence must be authentic. A student who is suspected of submitting fraudulent evidence (including medical certificates) will be reported to the responsible officer for academic misconduct (see the Student Academic Integrity Procedure).

2.8. If a staff member suspects that a professional practitioner has acted improperly in providing supporting documentation in support of special consideration, the matter must be reported to the Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Education).

2.9. The University is entitled to:

- verify the authenticity of any supporting evidence directly with the person or authority who has prepared the document, without giving notice to the student; and

- seek further detail directly from the student to gain a better understanding of the student's capacity to complete an assessment and, where possible, to provide guidance and support.

2.10. The Safer Community Unit (or equivalent for international locations) can recommend to Student Services that they vary the evidence requirements, or the application timeframes, for a student who is a victim of crime, including gender-based violence, sexual harm or family violence, so the student can apply for special consideration.

TABLE 1: Exceptional circumstances and supporting evidence required for special consideration applications

Exceptional circumstances, including but not limited to:	Description	Accepted supporting documentation and requirements
Scheduled medical procedure or serious medical condition	Includes hospital admission and recent hospital discharge, serious injury, serious illness (e.g. influenza), severe asthma, severe anxiety or depression.	Evidence from the following practitioners which must be dated and state that the student was unfit to study or undertake an assessment on a particular date, or period of time, that occurred on or before the relevant assessment due date. Accepted documents include: **Medical certificate**: following consultations between the student and health professional (such as a medical practitioner, pharmacist or psychologist). This includes video consultations with telehealth services; or **Medical letter of support:** only when the student was unable to obtain a medical certificate on the date they were affected by the exceptional circumstances. Where this type of evidence is provided, the health professional must have knowledge of the student's medical history and/or medical condition, and demonstrate that it was reasonable to assume the illness was present around the time of the student's assessment due date. **Practitioner certificate**: provided by other persons registered with a relevant professional body, such as social worker, physiotherapist or rehabilitation specialist; **Registration with Disability Support Services (DSS)**: Students registered with DSS and approved for flexible deadlines do not need to provide additional documentation unless the extension request exceeds ten (10) calendar days. On a case-by-case basis, staff can obtain further advice from DSS on the student's condition and recommendation for assessment adjustments in the reports available.
Loss or bereavement	Includes death of a close family member or person with whom the student had a significant relationship.	Evidence that demonstrates the significance of the loss or bereavement to the student and when the immediate impact occurred. Accepted documents include: **Death notice or certificate:** accompanied by a student statement demonstrating the significant relationship and impact of the loss; or **Practitioner certificate:** provided by persons registered with a relevant professional body, such as medical practitioners, psychologists, counsellors, social workers or lawyers; or **Police report**; or **Statutory declaration:** (or equivalent) from the student or other relevant persons.

Exceptional circumstances, including but not limited to:	Description	Accepted supporting documentation and requirements
Family relationship breakdown	Includes severe disruption to domestic arrangements.	Accepted documents include: **Medical certificate**: following consultations between the individual and health professional (such as a medical practitioner, pharmacist, or psychologist). This includes video consultations with telehealth services; or **Medical letter of support:** only when the individual was unable to obtain a medical certificate on the date they were affected by the exceptional circumstances. **Police or court report**; or **Practitioner certificate:** provided by practitioners registered with a relevant professional body, such as social workers and lawyers; or **Letter or document:** provided by a court, a district or maternal and child health care nurse, a relevant family support service**;** or **Statutory declaration:** (or equivalent) from the student or other relevant persons.
Gender-based violence	Includes family violence, sexual harm and other gender-based violence	Accepted documents include the following: **Medical certificate**: following consultations between the individual and health professional (such as a medical practitioner, pharmacist, or psychologist). This includes video consultations with telehealth services; or **Medical letter of support:** only when the individual was unable to obtain a medical certificate on the date they were affected by the exceptional circumstances. **Monash Safer Community Unit letter of support:** for victim-survivors of gender-based violence, victim-survivors of family violence, and victim-survivors of sexual harm, as well as victims of violent crime; or **Police report**; or **Practitioner certificate:** provided by practitioners registered with a relevant professional body, such as social workers, counsellors, financial advisers and lawyers; or **Letter or document:** provided by a current or former employer**;** or **Statutory declaration:** (or equivalent) from the student or other relevant persons. Monash acknowledges that students affected by gender-based violence may not be in a position to provide evidence or documentation. In such cases, the Monash Safer Community Unit will support students (including by providing a letter) to complete their application.
Hardship or trauma	Includes, but is not limited to: victims of crime; sudden loss of income or employment; serious illness in their family or person for whom they care.	Where the application is based on a serious illness in their family or person for whom they care, the documentation must make this relationship clear. Accepted documents include the following: **Medical certificate**: following consultations between the individual and health professional (such as a medical practitioner, pharmacist, or psychologist). This includes video consultations with telehealth services; or **Medical letter of support:** only when the individual was unable

Exceptional circumstances, including but not limited to:	Description	Accepted supporting documentation and requirements
		to obtain a medical certificate on the date they were affected by the exceptional circumstances. Where this type of evidence is provided, the health professional must have knowledge of the medical history and/or medical condition, and demonstrate that it was reasonable to assume the illness or impact was present around the time of the student's assessment due date. **Monash Safer Community Unit letter of support;** for victims of violent crime, victim-survivors of sexual harm, victim-survivors of family violence and victim-survivors of gender-based violence; or **Police or court report**; or **Practitioner certificate:** provided by practitioners registered with a relevant professional body, such as social workers, counsellors, financial advisers and lawyers**;** or **Letter or document:** provided by a current or former employer; or **Statutory declaration:** (or equivalent) from the student or other relevant persons.
Obligations to military, jury or emergency services	Including obligations to the Country Fire Authority or other civic obligations recognised in international locations.	**Statement from the appropriate authority**, for example, the Defence Reservist's Military Unit, Juries Commissioner's Office; or Country Fire Authority. The evidence must state the relevant dates of the obligation.
Student athletes, artists, performers and representatives	Including: ● athletes or performers registered with the Elite Student Performer Support; ● representing the University in other key events and programs (e.g. debating).	**Statement from the appropriate authority**, including: ● registration with the Elite Student Performer Support; or ● a faculty or other appropriate area of the University, for engagement activities where the student represents or volunteers on behalf of the University. The evidence must state the relevant dates of the student's obligation.
Carer responsibilities	Where exceptional circumstances, as listed in this table, affect the person they care for and the carer (student's) ability to undertake the assessment.	Students with caring responsibilities who are not registered with DSS, must provide evidence to show that the exceptional circumstances (as listed in this table) affect the person for whom they care, and that the student's ability to undertake assessment was affected by those circumstances. Student carers registered with DSS and approved for flexible deadlines do not need to provide additional documentation unless the extension request exceeds ten (10) calendar days.
Religious or cultural obligations	Including: ● students who hold strict religious observance (which conflict with scheduled assessments); ● students with cultural duties and ceremonial obligations	**A personal letter of support** from an official cultural or faith leader outlining their relationship with the student and explaining how the obligation will prevent the student from attempting or completing the assessment task; or **Statutory declaration** (or equivalent) from the student or other relevant persons.
Other exceptional circumstances	Including a natural disaster or a serious accident/incident	Sufficient evidence that is appropriate to the exceptional circumstances and that shows the student has experienced or is experiencing the circumstances.

Exceptional circumstances, including but not limited to:	Description	Accepted supporting documentation and requirements
Major known University technical disruption during a mid-semester test, in-class test or scheduled final assessment	The circumstances include: • major or continuous disruption to power and/or internet service provision; and • online assessment platform outage.	**No evidence is required**. Students are automatically granted special consideration in the form of an alternative assessment or a deferred assessment if an extension of time was not possible on the day. An application is not required. Students must be available to sit the alternative assessment or deferred assessment at the time scheduled by the University.
Technical disruption during a mid-semester test, in-class test or scheduled final assessment for an individual student	The circumstances must be beyond the student's control and include: • major or continuous disruption to power and/or internet service provision; and • major technical issues with computer hardware (e.g. screen malfunction, fan malfunction).	Students must make every effort to contact the Exam IT Support Desk, report the issue and submit an application for special consideration as soon as possible but not later than 11:55pm (the time zone of the unit location) on the due date of the affected assessment task. See 2.11. In support of their application, students must provide either: • **Screenshots or photos (including timestamps where appropriate) of the technical issue are required**. For example, error messages, screen not loading, time stamped speed tests or communication from electricity provider regarding the issue/outage experienced; or • **Statutory declaration** (or equivalent) from the student or other relevant persons. This can be submitted without an Exam IT Support Desk issue log number if it was not possible for the student to submit it at the time of the disruption.

Applying for special consideration

2.11. Eligible students must submit an application and supporting documentation via the special consideration application form as soon as possible, but no later than 11.55pm (time zone of the unit location) on the due date of the affected assessment task.

2.11.1. Students who are unable to submit supporting documentation by the application deadline due to circumstances beyond their control can provide this up to three calendar days after the deadline. The reasons for the delay must be provided in the application form. The application will only be assessed when all correct documentation is received.

2.11.2. For ongoing delays with accessing the required documentation beyond the three calendar days, the student must indicate a date in the application form by which the supporting documentation will be provided and provide evidence to support the reasons for the delay. The application will only be assessed when all the correct documentation is received.

2.11.3. Where supporting documentation has not been provided within three calendar days of the student's application date or date the student indicated in the application form that the documentation would be available, and no reason has been provided, the application will be cancelled.

2.11.4. In extreme circumstances where a student has been unable to apply by the deadline (e.g. hospitalisation), the responsible officers in Student Services will review the student's circumstances to determine if a late application can be accepted. Evidence of the extreme circumstances that prevented the student from applying by the deadline must be included in the application.

2.11.5. Applications submitted after the student's final results have been released for the teaching period will not be accepted under any circumstances.

Assessing the application - Student Services

2.12. Student Services will assess each application for special consideration, determine the outcome and notify the student (see 2.21 and 2.22).

2.13. An application can be declined for the following reasons:

- the dates on the supporting evidence do not correspond with the dates the student was affected by the exceptional circumstances;

- the supporting evidence does not demonstrate that the circumstances impacted the student's ability to undertake the assessment task;
- the extension request is for a prolonged extension (see 2.33);
- failure to submit the required evidence without an explanation;
- submission of fraudulent evidence (including medical certificates) (see 2.7);
- unclear or illegible documentation; or
- failure to produce the original or certified documents on request.

2.14. Student Services will provide a special consideration dashboard for faculties and international locations to view the progress of and outcomes of all special consideration applications received.

Complex arrangements

2.15. Complex arrangements are required when an extension for a specific assessment task is not possible. Assessment tasks that may have complex arrangements include placements, quizzes and group assessments.

2.16. Complex arrangements must be communicated to Student Services in the specified manner and timeframe.

2.17. Complex arrangements may also be required for extension requests longer than 10 calendar days (this may be less for teaching periods with less than 12 teaching weeks) or for assessments that have a due date during the teaching period and the requested extension goes beyond the end of the teaching period.

2.18. Where Student Services has determined that a student is eligible for special consideration for an assessment with complex arrangements, Student Services will advise the chief examiner (or delegate), who will determine and advise the student of the outcome.

2.19. Where an extension cannot be accommodated, the chief examiner (or delegate) may either:

- provide an alternative assessment (see 6.11 of the Assessment Regime Procedure); or
- exempt the student from completing the task if the assessment is weighted 10 per cent or less (see Table 2).

2.20. Where special consideration has been approved for one or more students in a group assessment task, the chief examiner (or delegate) will determine and advise students in the group of the following:

- whether an alternative assessment task is given to the affected student/s;
- the method for marking the work of the remaining group members; and
- whether all members of the group will be granted an extension.

Responses to special consideration applications

2.21. For complete applications for special consideration for assessments, excluding scheduled final assessments, Student Services will notify students of the outcome by email within three working days of receiving the complete application. If the application cannot be assessed within that time frame, Student Services will notify the student of the different response date, up to a maximum of an additional five working days.

2.22. For complete applications for special consideration for scheduled final assessments, Student Services will notify students of the outcome by email within two working days of receiving the complete application.

Outcomes of a special consideration application

2.23. The available outcomes of a special consideration application are set out in Table 2.

TABLE 2: Outcomes of special consideration applications

Outcome	Description
An extension is approved	For an approved application, the extension length is generally no longer than 10 calendar days and commensurate to the student's circumstances. This may be less for teaching periods with less than 12 teaching weeks. The revised due date can be any day except a University holiday or a day on which the student has a scheduled final assessment. Where the application is approved for a mid-semester, in-class test or a practical assessment, one new date to complete the task may be provided, taking into consideration the student's circumstances and any scheduling limitations. Any further special consideration on the same assessment is limited to extreme circumstances beyond the student's control that directly impacted their ability to undertake the assessment (see 3.8) on one further occasion.

Outcome	Description
An alternative and equivalent form of assessment is provided	Section 6.11 of the Assessment Regime Procedure sets out the characteristics of alternative assessment tasks. Where an alternative assessment is provided to the student, an extension is no longer available and the student must complete the alternative assessment.
An exemption from completing the task is provided	For applications where the eligible assessment task is weighted 10 percent or less (see 2.25). The dean (or delegate) of the teaching faculty will determine which tasks are eligible for this outcome.
A deferred final assessment is provided	For applications for scheduled final assessments only. The University will set the date of the assessment as per the Scheduled Final Assessments Procedure.
Special consideration is declined	The application will be declined where the student does not meet the eligibility requirements. Where the application was declined for a deferred assessment, the relevant BOE will finalise the results for the unit based on the completed tasks. Where the student is unable to complete the assessment for the unit within the maximum timeline set out in 2.29, the application will be declined and it will be recommended that the student applies for special circumstances, as set out in section 4.

2.24. Where special consideration for an assessment task has been approved for a given set of circumstances, further special consideration in that task for the same circumstances will require a new application with evidence demonstrating the need for further special consideration (see 2.11).

Outcomes for low weighted assessment tasks

2.25. An exemption from completing the task can only be applied in the following circumstances:

- the task is weighted 10 per cent or less of the unit's assessment;
- the task is not a hurdle or part of a hurdle requirement; and
- if multiple exemptions are granted for the same unit, the total weighting of exempted tasks must not be more than 10 per cent of the unit's assessment.

2.26. If an exemption is granted, the unit marks will be adjusted as follows:

- if the task is one component of an assessment item (e.g. one weekly quiz in an item of 'ten weekly quizzes, 20 per cent'), the mark for the whole item will be calculated as a percentage of the completed components; or
- if the task is a whole assessment item (e.g. 'discussion board comments, 10 per cent'), the final unit mark will be calculated as a percentage of the remaining assessment tasks for the unit.

Monitoring special consideration applications and outcomes for students

2.27. The chief examiner, via the special consideration dashboard, can view approved extensions and the revised submission date for each student. A late penalty must not be applied if the student submits the assessment by the revised submission date.

2.28. The chief examiner will inform the associate dean (education) of any extensions that extend beyond the date of the Board of Examiners (BOE) for the unit.

Extensions beyond the end of the final assessment period

2.29. In extreme circumstances and where a student is eligible for an extension that will extend beyond the end of the final assessment period, Student Services will discuss the application with the associate dean (education) (or delegate) of the teaching faculty before a decision is made. If approved, the extension will not be permitted beyond 90 calendar days of the result release date of the teaching period.

2.30. Where appropriate, Student Services may recommend that the student applies for special circumstances, as set out in section 4.

Supporting students with multiple applications and prolonged extension requests

2.31. Faculties are responsible for monitoring the number of students who have submitted multiple short extension and/or special consideration applications via the special consideration dashboard.

2.32. To support students, faculties will refer students to appropriate support services, including recommending they request course advice. Where appropriate, faculties may recommend to the student that they take intermission or withdraw from the unit.

2.33. Where the requested extension date is prolonged and extends for several weeks of the teaching period and/or beyond the end of the teaching period, Student Services may decline the application and recommend that the student instead applies for special circumstances (see section 4).

3. Deferred final assessment

3.1. The date of deferred scheduled final assessments will be set in accordance with the Scheduled Final Assessments Procedure.

3.2. The student must complete the deferred final assessment within 90 calendar days of the result release date of the teaching period.

3.3. If a student attends the scheduled final assessment after being approved for a deferred assessment, the special consideration decision will be revoked. The student will not be permitted to sit the deferred assessment and the mark for the original final assessment will be included in their final mark. No further special consideration applications for the assessment task will be accepted.

Rescheduling a deferred final assessment

3.4. Students can apply to reschedule a deferred final scheduled assessment on one further occasion.

3.5. Students cannot apply to reschedule a supplementary assessment, or an additional assessment on a competency hurdle task (see Assessment Regime Procedure, sections 5.6 and 4.16).

3.6. Students must apply to Student Services, using the relevant form, by 11.55pm (time zone of the unit location) on the due date of the affected assessment task.

3.6.1. Students who are unable to submit supporting evidence by application deadline can provide this up to three calendar days after the deadline if there were circumstances beyond their control which prevented them from providing this on time. The reasons for the delay must be provided in the impact statement.

3.6.2. If circumstances beyond the student's control have prevented the application being submitted by 11.55pm (time zone of the unit location) on the due date of the affected assessment task, supporting evidence of the delay must be provided.

3.6.3. Applications submitted after the student's final results have been released for the unit teaching period will not be accepted.

3.6.4. Where supporting documentation has not been provided within seven calendar days of the student's application date or date the student indicated in the application form that the documentation would be available, and no reason has been provided, the application will be cancelled.

3.7. Student Services will acknowledge receipt of the application within two working days.

3.8. To be eligible to apply to reschedule a deferred final scheduled assessment, students must:

- be registered with DSS and have an ongoing condition, that has directly prevented their ability to undertake the deferred final assessment; or
- demonstrate that the circumstances for which the deferred final scheduled assessment was granted are unresolved; or
- demonstrate the existence of extreme circumstances beyond their control, which have directly impacted their ability to undertake the deferred final assessment. This includes:
  - a serious and debilitating medical condition;
  - severe mental health condition;
  - the experience of gender-based violence;
  - death of a person with whom they had a significant relationship;
  - obligations to emergency or military service or civic obligations; and/or
  - other extreme circumstances beyond their control such as a natural disaster or a serious accident;
- be able to complete the rescheduled assessment within 90 calendar days of the result release date of the teaching period in which the original scheduled assessment was held.

3.9. The student must provide supporting evidence that demonstrates their circumstances meet the criteria in section 3.8.

3.9.1. Monash acknowledges that students affected by gender-based violence may not be in a position to provide evidence or documentation. In such cases, the Monash Safer Community Unit will support students (including by providing a letter) to complete their application.

Determining the outcome of a rescheduled assessment application

3.10. Student Services will assess the application, determine the student's eligibility and inform the student and dean (or nominee) of the teaching faculty of the outcome within five working days of receiving a complete application.

3.11. Where a rescheduled assessment has been approved, the dean (or delegate) of the teaching faculty:

- will consult with the chief examiner and the associate dean (education), if required, to determine the appropriate manner to vary the assessment regime for the student, considering any professional accreditation requirements. This can be a rescheduled deferred assessment or an alternative assessment task (of equivalent learning outcomes);
- will schedule or set the due date of the assessment within the maximum time limit (see 3.8, last point);
- may request that the student meet with a course adviser to discuss and develop a study plan to manage their course progression. The student can take a support person to the meeting; and
- may set enrolment conditions until the rescheduled assessment has been completed, taking into consideration the impact on student visas, government benefits or scholarships.

3.12. Students who have applied for a rescheduled deferred assessment may instead be awarded a withdrawn (WDN) grade by Student Services, if:

- the student was approved for a rescheduled deferred assessment but was unable to complete it within the maximum time limit, and notified the University prior to the time of the rescheduled deferred assessment; or
- the student was unable to provide the complete supporting documentation required for the application to be assessed on time and the assessment was not able to be scheduled within the maximum time limit.

3.13. Assessments will only be scheduled beyond the maximum time limit in cases of unexpected delays caused by University administrative processes.

3.14. If a student attends the deferred assessment after being approved, or applying, to have their deferred assessment rescheduled, the decision will be revoked or the application declined. The student will not be permitted to sit a rescheduled deferred assessment and the mark for the deferred assessment they attended will be included in their final mark. No further special consideration applications for the assessment task will be accepted.

4. Withdrawn (WDN) grade awarded in special circumstances

4.1. In certain circumstances, students who are prevented from successfully completing a unit may be awarded a withdrawn (WDN) grade even after the withdrawn fail date. A withdrawn (WDN) grade does not count towards the Grade Point Average (GPA) or Weighted Average Mark (WAM).

4.2. A student is eligible for a withdrawn (WDN) grade if they:

- meet the criteria for special circumstances set out in the Student Fees - Refunds Procedure; and
- apply for special circumstances within the time period set out in 4.3-4.4 below in this procedure; and
- have no findings of academic misconduct against them in the unit.

4.3. To be considered for a withdrawn (WDN) grade, a student must apply for special circumstances within 10 working days from the official unit results release date.

4.3.1. A student who has an interim result (WH, DEF, NS) at the time of results release, or who has had a correction to their mark, must apply within 10 working days of being notified that their result has been finalised.

4.4. Where a student is prevented from submitting an application within the time period specified above in 4.3 or 4.3.1 (as appropriate) due to circumstances beyond their control, the Senior Director, Student Services (or delegate) can approve a longer application period. Applications for extensions must include evidence of the circumstances and demonstrate that they were beyond the student's control. If approved, the extension to apply will be proportionate to the circumstances.

4.4.1. The Safer Community Unit (or equivalent for international locations) can recommend to the Senior Director, Student Services (or delegate) an extension to the application time period in section 4.3 for a student who is a victim of sexual harm, family or domestic violence.

4.5. In the event that a student has applied for special circumstances and there is an allegation of academic misconduct that has not yet been determined, the student's application will be assessed after the misconduct investigation has concluded.

4.6. Student Services can:

- approve a withdrawn (WDN) grade; or
- deny the application, providing reasons for the decision.

4.7. Student Services will notify the student of their decision, including the reasons for the outcome, within 20 working days of the complete application, including all required evidence, being submitted.

5. Evaluation and reporting

5.1. Student Services will undertake regular moderation activities to ensure applications are being assessed consistently, equitably and according to this procedure.

5.2. Student Services will regularly engage with faculties and international locations for feedback and ongoing process improvement.

5.3. The Senior Director, Student Services (or nominee) will submit regular reports to the University Education Committee and Academic Board:

- a twice-yearly report on special consideration, highlighting trends, number of applications, categories of applications received, response times; processing timelines, process improvements and addressing risk and quality issues; and
- an annual report on withdrawn grades awarded through special consideration and special circumstances processes, highlighting trends and addressing any quality issues.

DEFINITIONS

Authorised translation	A translation by a professionally accredited translation service.
Chief examiner	The academic staff member responsible for the implementation of a unit's assessment regime and for recommending the final result for each student. A dean must appoint a chief examiner for each unit taught by the faculty.
Deferred assessment	A final assessment that has been delayed to a later date, normally resulting from a successful application for special consideration.
Disability	In relation to a person, means: • total or partial loss of the person's bodily or mental functions; • total or partial loss of a part of the body; • the presence in the body of organisms causing disease or illness; • the presence in the body of organisms capable of causing disease or illness; • the malfunction, malformation or disfigurement of a part of the person's body; • a disorder or malfunction that results in the person learning differently from a person without the disorder or malfunction; or • a disorder, illness or disease that affects a person's thought processes, perception of reality, emotions or judgment or that results in disturbed behaviour; and includes a disability that: • presently exists; • previously existed but no longer exists; • may exist in the future (including because of a genetic predisposition to that disability); or • is imputed to a person. To avoid doubt, a disability that is otherwise covered by this definition includes behaviour that is a symptom or manifestation of the disability. [Note: this definition is taken from the Disability Discrimination Act 1992]
Difficult circumstances	For the purpose of this procedure, difficult circumstances are short term events preventing the student from working on their assignments for a day or two.
Exceptional circumstances	For the purpose of this procedure, exceptional circumstances are circumstances that could not be reasonably foreseen and due to which there was insufficient time to complete an assessment task. Exceptional circumstances are more severe in effect or duration than difficult circumstances and may prevent a student from working on an assessment for more than two days. Exceptional circumstances might include illness such as the flu or being a victim of a crime.
Extreme circumstances	For the purpose of this procedure, extreme circumstances are highly uncommon and severe situations beyond the student's control that prevent the student from studying for a longer than expected period of time.
Final assessment period	The period at the end of the teaching period where the final assessment for a unit may be scheduled or due for submission.

Health professional	A professional registered with the Australian Health Practitioner Regulation Agency or equivalent in other countries.
Major university technical disruption	A disruption to a scheduled final assessment declared by the Chief Information Officer (or delegate) and Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Education) (or delegate). The technical disruption: ● is a major or continuous disruption to power and/or internet service provision and prevents students from completing the assessment; or ● is major and the provision of additional time was not feasible; or ● is major and the assessment was irrecoverable.
Managing faculty	The faculty specified in the Handbook as being responsible for the administration of a course for the year for which the Handbook is published.
Medical certificate (or doctor's certificate)	A statement on the health professional's letterhead that includes the provider number, is signed by the health professional, and attests to the result of a face-to-face (including telehealth) medical consultation with the student.
Medical letter of support	A statement on the health professional's letterhead, signed by the professional which attests, based on the patient's medical history and on information provided, that the student would have been unfit to undertake the assessment on the relevant date or unable to complete work for assessment on or before the relevant date.
Scheduled final assessment	A timed major assessment task that is scheduled during the final scheduled period for the teaching period (previously known as 'examination').
Statutory declaration	A statutory declaration is a legal document that contains a written statement about something that is true. It must be witnessed by an approved witness and must include: ● your full name ● your address ● your occupation ● a statement that you "do solemnly and sincerely declare".
Strict religious observance obligations	Practices required by a religious doctrine to be precisely obeyed by followers of the religion. These are recognised in Article 18 of the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights.
Student carer	A student registered with Disability Support Services as a student carer (as defined by the Carer Recognition Act 2010) who is an individual that provides personal care, support and assistance to another individual who needs it because the other individual has a disability, a medical condition (including a terminal or chronic illness), has a mental illness or is aged and frail. A person is not a carer merely because they are the spouse, de facto partner, parent, child, other relative or the guardian of an individual or because they live with an individual who requires care.
Teaching faculty	The faculty responsible for teaching the unit as specified in the University Handbook. Where teaching is shared among faculties, it is the faculty with the greatest percentage of teaching responsibility.
Teaching period	A defined period in which units may be offered for study and which is published as such on the University's website. A teaching period includes the weeks in which classes are delivered and the concurrent assessment and marking weeks up until the end of the final assessment period..
Teaching weeks	The weeks in a teaching period where teaching, learning and assessment for a unit takes place and teaching activities for the unit can be scheduled.
Working day	A day other than a Saturday or Sunday, a public holiday under the Public Holidays Act 1993 (Vic), or university holiday. In Malaysia, working day means a day other than a Saturday, Sunday or a public holiday in the relevant state in Malaysia. In Indonesia, working day means a day other than a Saturday, Sunday or a public holiday, including joint holidays/mass leave.

GOVERNANCE

Parent policy	Assessment and Academic Integrity Policy
Supporting procedures	Assessment Regime Procedure

	Grading Schema Procedure Marking and Feedback Procedure Scheduled Final Assessments Procedure Student Academic Integrity Procedure
Supporting schedules	N/A
Associated procedures	Data Protection and Privacy Procedure Equal Opportunity Policy Student Complaints Procedure Student Fees Procedure
Related legislation	Monash University (Academic Board) Regulations, 20-22 Disability Discrimination Act 1992 (Cth) Disability Standards for Education 2005 (Cth) Racial Discrimination Act 1975 (Cth) Higher Education Standards Framework (Threshold Standards) 2021 (Cth) Equal Opportunity Act 2010 (Vic)
Category	Academic
Approval	University Education Committee 3 February 2025 MEETING NUMBER 1/2025 / AGENDA ITEM 14.1
Endorsement	Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Education) 30 January 2025
Procedure owner	Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Education)
Date effective	3 March 2025
Review date	3 March 2028
Version	8.1 (*Minor amendments effective 2 March 2026*)
Content enquiries	policy-education@monash.edu